

UKUVA

Listen. Then Do.

Concept Brief for Landing Page and Brand Development

Prepared for: Jessica (It's a Shovel) | June 2025

1. The Concept

Ukuva is a personal executive service for busy, ambitious people who have a vision, a business idea, or a problem that needs solving, but simply do not have the time or capacity to make it happen.

You have the idea. I will make it real.

This is not consulting. There are no reports that sit in drawers. There are no recommendations without accountability. Ukuva is about activation: listening properly, understanding completely, and then going out into the world and doing the work.

The name says it. In isiXhosa, ukuva means to listen. That is where everything starts. But listening without doing is just noise. The full offer is: listen and do.

2. The Problem Being Solved

The people this service is built for are not short of ability or ambition. They are short of bandwidth. Their days are already full running what they have already built. The ideas stack up. The execution never comes.

Most available solutions fail them:

- Consultants produce documents and move on
- Agencies need constant direction and hand-holding
- Virtual assistants lack the seniority to act independently
- Cofounders want equity, shared control, and long-term commitment

What they actually need is someone senior enough to understand the full picture, experienced enough to navigate any environment, networked enough to get things moving fast, and driven enough to just get it done without needing to be managed.

3. The Offer

Ukuva operates as a personal executive service with a structured engagement model. The work is done remotely from the Netherlands, with travel to clients wherever they are in the world when the engagement requires it.

How It Works

Phase	What Happens	Cost
Free Discovery Call (30 min)	We talk. You share your idea or challenge. I ask the right questions. We decide together if this is worth pursuing.	No charge
Operational Readiness Engagement	I travel to you. I immerse myself in your world. I come back with a clear Operational Readiness Blueprint: what it will take, how to do it, in what order.	From EUR 5,000 (fixed, non-refundable)
Execution (Optional)	You keep the Blueprint and execute it yourself. Or you engage me to do it. I work on your behalf, using my network and experience to make it real.	Quoted per engagement: fixed fee, project-based, or hourly

4. Engagement Principles

Maximum of Three Clients at Any Time

Quality of execution matters more than volume. Ukuva never takes on more than three active clients simultaneously. Every client gets full focus and genuine delivery accountability.

Not a Cofounder. Not a Consultant.

This is not a partnership and there is no equity arrangement. The relationship is clear: you have a vision, I execute on your behalf. When the mission is done, the engagement ends. There is no dependency created.

The Blueprint is Yours to Keep

The Operational Readiness Blueprint produced in Phase 1 belongs entirely to the client. It is non-refundable because the time, research, and expertise that goes into it are real. The client is free to execute it independently or to engage Ukuva to do it.

Travel on Engagement Terms

Base of operations is Amsterdam, Netherlands. Most work is done remotely. Where on-site presence is required, travel and accommodation costs are invoiced separately and transparently.

5. Who This Is For

Ukuva is built for a specific kind of person. They tend to have one or more of the following in common:

• A founder running one business with a second idea they cannot get to	• Someone entering a new market who needs the operational groundwork done
• An executive who wants to launch something on the side but has no time	• A person who has tried to delegate before and been let down
• A professional (doctor, lawyer, creative) with intellectual property they have never commercialised	• Anyone who is tired of complacency and needs someone with genuine hustle
• A business owner who has a plan and just needs someone to go execute it	• Someone who values straight-talking, culturally aware, globally connected execution

They have resources. They have ideas. What they need is someone they can trust to go and do it.

6. Why Christopher Savides

The service is built on a single person's experience, network, and mindset. That is not a limitation. It is the point. Clients are not buying a team of generalists. They are buying access to someone specific.

The Background

20 years of building, operating, and fixing businesses across fintech, payments, digital media, and streaming. Never as an external adviser. Always embedded, full-time, with real delivery accountability.

Period	Role	Sector / Focus
2024-2025	Chief of Staff, DT One (Dubai)	Global value transfer, 30+ markets, CEO strategic partner

2023-2024	GM Global Business Development, De Risk International (Amsterdam)	Consumer promotion and reward risk, multi-regional expansion
2023	Managing Director, Papaya Global / Azimo B.V. (Amsterdam)	Fintech, DNB regulatory compliance, board governance
2020-2022	Interim COO, Antenna (Amsterdam)	Streaming/SVOD, payments infrastructure, operations build-out
2018-2019	Interim CEO then COO, DT One / MODE (Nairobi and Singapore)	M&A integration, team restructuring, partner agreements
2018	Payment and FinOps Specialist, Fox Networks Group (Singapore)	Adyen integration, Fox+ SVOD platform
2015-2018	Head of Payments and African Operations, Showmax / Naspers (Amsterdam)	Founding team, Sub-Saharan Africa expansion, studio rights negotiation
2014-2015	General Manager, MultiChoice (Johannesburg)	Multimedia platform, mobile TV, ecommerce, single sign-on
2008-2014	Innovations Manager then GM PayPal Services, FNB / eBucks (Johannesburg)	Fintech, Reserve Bank regulatory approval, Kenya market entry

The Edge

There are three things that make this offer distinctive:

The Hustle Mentality

Growing up and building a career in South Africa means there is no safety net to fall back on. Every problem has to be solved, because the alternative is not an option. That mentality travels. It shows up in every engagement regardless of geography or industry.

The Global Footprint

Lived and worked in South Africa, Netherlands, Dubai, Singapore, Nairobi, and Czech Republic. Commercial partner engagement across Latin America, Sub-Saharan Africa, South East Asia, and the Middle East. When a client needs something done somewhere, there is usually a direct line to the right person.

The Cross-Functional Range

Regulatory navigation, payments infrastructure, content rights negotiation, team building, M&A integration, operational restructuring. The range means there is rarely a situation that is genuinely unfamiliar.

7. Case Studies (To Be Developed)

The following examples illustrate the type of work Ukuva is built for. These should be developed into short, outcome-focused stories for the landing page. Each should follow the same structure: the person, the problem, what was done, and what changed.

Case Study 1: Showmax, Sub-Saharan Africa Expansion

Founding team member of a streaming platform launching simultaneously into South Africa, Kenya, and Nigeria. Built the payments and subscription function from scratch. Negotiated content rights with Disney and Fox. Developed commercial frameworks with telcos, ISPs, and banks. Resolved structural conflict between product and engineering leadership. The business launched and scaled across the region.

Case Study 2: PayPal and FNB, South Africa

South Africans were blocked from accessing PayPal due to exchange control regulations. Built the regulatory case, secured Reserve Bank approval, and managed the full end-to-end development and launch of a joint solution across multiple organisations and time zones. Extended the same model into Kenya through a local banking partnership.

Case Study 3: DT One / MODE Acquisition Integration

Following an acquisition, stepped in first as COO in Singapore then as Interim CEO in Nairobi. Integrated the acquired business into the acquiring company's operational structure, recruited a new technical team in Czech Republic, and restructured partner agreements. The business emerged from the integration with a functioning team and operational continuity.

Note for Jessica: *Additional case studies can be developed from the Stretchy engagement (Luan), the Penzone/Manfred engagement, and the Australia-based medical professional concept. These are warm examples that can be told in first-person voice and will resonate directly with the target audience.*

8. Landing Page Structure (Brief for Jessica)

The landing page should be a single, focused page. No noise. No agency language. No corporate padding. It should feel like a direct conversation with one very capable, very direct person.

Suggested Section Order

Hero

One strong headline. One sentence of explanation. One clear call to action (Book the free 30-minute call). The tagline 'Listen. Then Do.' should be prominent but not cliché.

The Problem

A short, honest description of the gap this fills. Written in the language of the client, not the service provider. No jargon. The person reading this should feel immediately recognised.

How It Works

The three-phase model in simple, plain language. Emphasise that the Blueprint is theirs to keep. Make the pricing transparent. Transparency builds trust.

Why Me

A personal, direct section. Not a list of logos. Not a wall of credentials. A short, honest account of who Christopher is, where he has been, and why that matters for the client. The South African angle and the global footprint should both be present.

Case Studies

Two or three short outcome-focused stories. Each one should demonstrate a different type of activation: market entry, operational build, integration, or concept execution.

The Offer

A clean summary of the engagement model, pricing, and availability. Include the three-client limit. This signals quality and creates urgency without manufactured scarcity.

Contact and Booking

Simple. Direct. A Calendly link or equivalent for the free discovery call. An email address. Nothing else.

9. Tone and Brand Direction

The brand should feel like the person: direct, experienced, globally comfortable, and completely devoid of corporate filler. Key principles:

- Senior and confident: this is not a startup hustle brand, it is a seasoned operator brand
- Personal: Christopher is the product. The brand should reflect a human voice, not an agency
- Global but grounded: the international footprint is a feature, not just a background detail
- Transparent: pricing is visible, the model is clear, there is nothing to hide
- Direct: no 'we help you unlock your potential' language. Plain statements of what is done and what it costs

The name Ukuva and the tagline 'Listen. Then Do.' are strong anchors. The visual direction should be clean and professional: dark navy, warm gold, and white. No stock photography of handshakes or skylines. If photography is used, it should be real.

10. Immediate Next Steps

Before the landing page goes live, the following should be in place:

- Two or three case study stories written in first-person, outcome-focused voice
- A clear, one-paragraph personal bio that can be used on the page and on LinkedIn
- LinkedIn profile updated to reflect this positioning (away from 'consulting services', toward personal executive activation)
- A Calendly link or equivalent set up for the free 30-minute discovery call
- A simple outreach message drafted for warm contacts (Manfred, Luan, the Australia contact) who are potential first clients

The goal is not a perfect launch. The goal is a credible, clear presence that can be shared with a warm contact today. Perfection comes later. Activation comes first.